

◀ DOUGLAS A-20 HAVOC

Date 1942 **Origin** US
Wingspan 18.7m (61½ft)
Length 14.6m (48ft)
Top speed 549kph (340mph)
Engine Two 1,267.7kW (1,700hp) Wright R2600-A Twin Cyclone radials

The Havoc – “Boston” to the British RAF, which also operated it – was intended as a light/attack bomber, but also saw service as a night-fighter. A total of almost 7,500 were built by Douglas and Boeing between late 1939 and September 1944.

Crew of two

910kg (2,000lb) of bombs carried internally

Cockpit accommodated pilot and navigator side-by-side

Turbojets mounted below each wing

Pilot navigated without a co-pilot

Three-bladed variable-pitch propeller

▲ ARADO AR 234B-2

Date 1944 **Origin** Germany
Wingspan 14.1m (46¼ft)
Length 12.63m (41½ft)
Top speed 740kph (460mph)
Engine Two 900kg (1,985lb) Junkers Jumo 004B-1 turbojets

The second turbojet to enter service with the Luftwaffe, the Ar 234B-2 first flew in June 1943. Within a year it had proved to be a capable reconnaissance aircraft, and while this became its main role, it also flew a number of bombing missions, most notably an attempt to destroy the last remaining Rhine Bridge at Remagen.

Pilot very exposed in torpedo-like airframe

Warhead contained 1,200kg (2,650lb) of Amatol high explosive

▼ BOEING B-29A SUPERFORTRESS

Date 1944 **Origin** US
Wingspan 43.1m (141¼ft)
Length 30.2m (99ft)
Top speed 575kph (357mph)
Engine Four 1,640kW (2,200hp) Wright R-3350-23 Duplex Cyclone radials

The largest and most capable of the Allies' strategic bombers, with pressurized fuselage and remotely controlled guns, the B-29A first flew in September 1942, and was operational against targets in Japan (from a base in China) from June 1944. Its most famous missions were those that saw nuclear bombs dropped on the Japanese cities of Hiroshima (see pp. 378–79) and Nagasaki.

▲ YOKOSUKA MXY7 OHKA

Date 1944 **Origin** Japan
Wingspan 5.12m (16¾ft)
Length 6.06m (19¾ft)
Top speed 927kph (575mph)
Engine Three 266kg (587lb) Type 4 rocket motors

The Ohka was a manned flying bomb powered by three solid-fuel rocket motors. It was intended to be used against warships, and was carried to its target below a mother-aircraft – usually a Mitsubishi G4M “Betty”. Around 850 of the Ohka were produced, but only seven of them sank or damaged US ships. Several more successful kamikaze (see p. 342) attacks were carried out by conventional aircraft.

Remote-controlled ventral turret housed two .5in machine-guns

Pressurized fuselage